

“BURNING ZIKLAG”

TEXT: I SAMUEL 27:1-7; I SAMUEL 30:1-8

INTRO: David has been anointed by Samuel to be king over Israel.

Saul's jealousy causes him to hate David, thus he pursues David to kill him. "Saul hath killed his thousands, David his ten thousands."

David no doubt becomes weary with all the pressures of being pursued and he begins to take things into his own hands and makes plans to dwell in the Land of the Philistines. I Samuel 24:1-6, 26:2-9 - David has opportunity to kill Saul but refuses to.

David goes to Achish King of Gath - Achish allows him to dwell in the Royal City.

I personally don't believe that it was within the will of God for David to be in the land of the Philistines in the first place. Commitment in the bad times as well as the good times. Saul couldn't have killed David if he had wanted to.

David finally speaks to Achish and asks him to give him a city!

I SAMUEL 27:5-7

5) And David said unto Achish, If I have now found grace in thine eyes, let them give me a place in some town in the country, that I may dwell there; for why should thy servant dwell in the royal city with thee?

6) Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: wherefore Ziklag pertaineth unto the kings of Judah unto this day.

7) And the time that David dwelt in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months.

Let's look at the significance of Ziklag in our lives today!

I. ZIKLAG!!!

A. ZIKLAG represents a hiding place or refuge other than God! Most of the time it represents the path of least resistance.

Notice if you will, that David didn't stay in Ziklag all the time. He would go out from time to time, on Saul's turf and when the pressure was on he would return to Ziklag! **DAVID WAS EVEN WILLING TO HELP ACHISH FIGHT ISRAEL!** (Before Ziklag, David was unwilling to kill Saul.)

Let's look at some other people in God's word who had their own personal Ziklag!

NUMBERS 13:25-33

25) And they returned from searching of the land after forty days.

26) And they went and came to Moses, and to Aaron, and to all the congregation of the children of Israel, unto the wilderness of Paran, to Kadesh; and brought back word unto them, and unto all the congregation, and shewed them the fruit of the land.

27) And they told him, and said, We came unto the land whither thou sentest us, and surely it floweth with milk and honey; and this is the fruit of it.

28) Nevertheless the people be strong that dwell in the land, and the cities are walled, and very great: and moreover we saw the children of Anak, there.

29) The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south: and the Hittites, and the Jebusites, and the Amorites, dwell in the mountains: and the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and by the coast of Jordan.

30) And Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.

31) But the men that went up with him said, We be not able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we.

32) And they brought up an evil report of the land which they had searched unto the children of Israel, saying, The land, through which we have gone to search it, is a land that eateth up the inhabitants thereof; and all the people that we saw in it are men of a great stature.

33) And there we saw the giants, the sons of Anak, which come of the giants: and we were in our own sight as grasshoppers, and so we were in their sight.

Rather than to face the giants in the authority and power of Jehovah God, they preferred ZIKLAG- (Dying in the wilderness.)

I want you to note, that whether it's now or later the giants have to be faced, and dealt with. So in actuality ZIKLAG just delays the inevitable! I HAD A PERSONAL ZIKLAG UNTIL 1987 – WHAT I NEEDED TO DO WAS FACE THE GIANT OF FASTING!

B) Samson resorted to ZIKLAG!

His ZIKLAG was wordly pleasure! ZIKLAG presents itself in many different forms!

Samson's ZIKLAG cost him dearly!

JUDGES 16:19-31

19) And she made him sleep upon her knees; and she called for a man, and she caused him to shave off the seven locks of his head; and she began to afflict him, and his strength went from him.

20) And she said, The Philistines be upon thee, Samson. And he awoke out of his sleep, and said, I will go out as at other times before, and shake myself. And he wist not that the LORD was departed from him.

- 21) But the Philistines took him, and put out his eyes, and brought him down to Gaza, and bound him with fetters of brass; and he did grind in the prison house.
- 22) Howbeit the hair of his head began to grow again after he was shaven.
- 23) Then the lords of the Philistines gathered them together for to offer a great sacrifice unto Dagon their god, and to rejoice for they said, Our god hath delivered Samson our enemy into our hand.
- 24) And when the people saw him, they praised their god: for they said, Our god hath delivered into our hands our enemy, and the destroyer of our country, which slew many of us.
- 25) And it came to pass, when their hearts were merry, that they said, Call for Samson, that he may make us sport. And they called for Samson out of the prison house; and he made them sport: and they set him between the pillars.
- 26) And Samson said unto the lad that held him by the hand, Suffer me that I may feel the pillars whereupon the house standeth, that I may lean upon them.
- 27) Now the house was full of men and women; and all the lords of the Philistines were there; and there were upon the roof about three thousand men and women, that beheld while Samson made sport.
- 28) And Samson called unto the LORD, and said, O Lord God, remember me, I pray thee, and strengthen me, I pray thee, only this once, O God, that I may be at once avenged of the Philistines for my two eyes.
- 29) And Samson took hold of the two middle pillars upon which the house stood, and on which it was borne up, of the one with his right hand, and of the other with his left.
- 30) And Samson said, Let me die with the Philistines. And he bowed himself with all his might; and the house fell upon the lords, and upon all the people that were therein. So the dead which he slew at his death were more than they which he slew in his life.
- 31) Then his brethren and all the house of his father came down, and took him, and brought him up, and buried him between Zorah and Eshtaol in the burying place of Manoah his father. And he judged Israel twenty years.

II. THE BURNING OF ZIKLAG!

A. David didn't burn ZIKLAG himself – the Amelekites done it for him!

Sixteen months of retreating, hiding from the enemy, and ZIKLAG BURNS!

Notice the devastation of these men at THE BURNING OF ZIKLAG!

I SAMUEL 30:3-4

- 3) So David and his men came to the city, and, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captives.

4) Then David and the people that were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep.

My friend your ZIKLAG will eventually be destroyed one way or another, whether you do it willingly or it happens outside your will!

(a) UNWILLINGLY! JONAH!

JONAH 4:5-11

5) So Jonah went out of the city, and sat on the east side of the city, and there made him a booth, and sat under it in the shadow, till he might see what would become of the city.

6) And the Lord God prepared a gourd, and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shadow over his head, to deliver him from his grief. So Jonah was exceeding glad of the gourd.

7) But God prepared a worm when the morning rose the next day, and it smote the gourd that it withered.

8) And it came to pass, when the sun did arise, that God prepared a vehement east wind; and the sun beat upon the head of Jonah, that he fainted, and wished in himself to die, and said, It is better for me to die than to live.

9) And God said to Jonah, Doest thou well to be angry for the gourd? And he said, I do well to be angry, even unto death.

10) Then said the Lord, Thou hast had pity on the gourd, for the which thou hast not labored, neither madest it grow; which came up in a night, and perished in a night:

11) And should not I spare Nin-e-veh, that great city, wherein are more than sixscore thousand persons that cannot discern between their right hand and their left hand; and also much cattle?

b) WILLINGLY! GIDEON!

Judges 6:25-31

25) And it came to pass the same night, that the Lord said unto him, Take thy father's young bullock, even the second bullock of seven years old, and throw down the altar of Ba-al that th father hath, and cut down the grove that is by it:

26) And build an altar unto the Lord thy God upon the top of this rock, in the ordered place, and take the second bullock and offer a burnt sacrifice with the wood of the grove which thou shalt cut down.

27) Then Gideon took ten men of his servants, and did as the lord had said unto him: and so it was, because he feared his father's household, and the men of the city, that he could not do it by day, that he did it by night.

28) And when the men of the city rose early in the morning, behold, the altar of Ba-al was cast down, and the grove was cut down that was by it, and the second bullock was offered upon the altar that was built.

29) And they said one to another, Who hath done this thing? And when they inquired and asked, they said, Gideon the son of Jo-ash hath done this thing.

30) Then the men of the city said unto Jo-ash, Bring out thy son, that he may die: because he hath cast down the altar of Ba-al, and because he hath cut down the grove that way by it.

31) And Jo-ash said unto all that stood against him, Will ye plead for Ba-al? Will ye save him? He that will plead for him, let him be put to death whilst it is yet morning: if he be a god, let him plead for himself, because one hath cast down his altar.

Gideon put his fleece before God. God answers!

Gideon goes toward the Battle with 32,000 men. God says it's too many! Gideon says anyone who is afraid go home, he is left with 10,000 men!

God says you've still got too many men, take them to the river let them drink, and those who lapped water from his hand, keep him! But those who get down on their knees to drink, send them home! 9,700 men went home!

Gideon is left with 300 men!

Notice the victory!

Judges 7:12-18

12) And the Mid-i-a-nites and the A-mal-ek-ites and all the children of the east lay along in the valley like grasshoppers for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand by the seaside for multitude.

13) And when Gideon was come, behold, there was a man that told a dream unto his fellow, and said, Behold, I dreamed a dream, and, lo, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the host of Mid-i-an, and came unto a tent and smote it that it fell, and overturned it, that the tent lay along.

14) And his fellow answered and said, This is nothing else save the sword of Gideon the son of Jo-ash a man of Israel: for into his hand hath God delivered Mid-i-an and all the host.

15) And it was so, when Gideon heard the telling of the dream, and the interpretation thereof, that he worshipped, and returned into the host of Israel and said, Arise; for the Lord hath delivered into your hand the host of Mid-i-an.

16) And he divided the three hundred men into three companies and he put a trumpet in every man's hand, with empty pitchers, and lamps within the pitchers.

17) And he said unto them, Look on me, and do likewise: and, behold, when I come to the outside of the camp, it shall be that, as I do, so shall ye do.

18) When I blow with a trumpet, I and all that are with me, ten blow ye the trumpets also on every side of all the camp, and say, The sword of the Lord, and of Gideon.

Why such a victory?

Because ZIKLAG had been burned!

III. WHAT ARE YOU GOING TO DO ABOUT YOUR ZIKLAG?

30:11 David in pursuit of the enemies who had burned Ziklag, finds an Egyptian, who had been left behind because he was sick, fed him and restored him and he led them to the enemies, and David recovered all!!!

1st A/G Fouke (?) AR 8/16/89 p.m.

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1st A/G London 3/14/91

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1st A/G Mooreland AR 1 Gifford A/G Malvern AR 11/27/93 p.m.

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